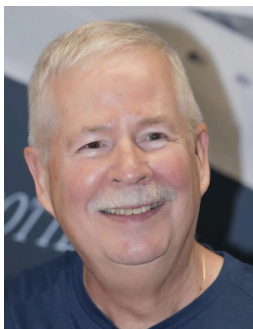




LOGO AND DESIGN CREATED BY CRISTINA VARGAS GASCA

A Message from the Chair



Greg O'Grady,
Chair, NLSA

HAPPY 2026! Hoping that you and family had a great Festive Holiday Season. As we start 2026 the Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association wish you and family all the best for 2026 and to thank you for being such an integral part of our NL stuttering community

Now we are back to business for an exciting year ahead Advocating and Supporting the NL Stuttering Community. As evident in our 2025 AGM Report and in our Monthly Newsletters we have several exciting projects and initiatives underway. Projects such as the government funded MUN/NLSA Accessibility Project and our 1st Joint CSA/NLSA Collaborative Conference, etc. These projects and initiatives will require community collaboration, commitment, engagement and support. We accomplished a lot in 2025, yet we have only touched the tip of the iceberg of accomplishments. The NL stuttering community continues to be a vulnerable community, a community that requires a ***'COLLECTIVE VOICE ECHOING VISIBILITY'***. There is so much more to be accomplished.

'Collectively we change lives forever'

Get Involved

From events and research to advocacy and outreach, the NLSA thrives on community involvement. If you'd like to volunteer, partner, or simply learn more, get in touch. There's always room for another voice at the table.

Email: info@nlstuttering.ca Website: www.nlstuttering.ca

ACCESSIBILITY PROJECT UPDATE



Amazingly and exciting new Updates!

- We are excited to announce that NL Schools has approved the Building Community and Accessibility for People Who Stutter in Newfoundland and Labrador research project! Our request to conduct education-related research at NL Schools has been approved. This approval affords us permission to engage fully with staff and students at NL Schools!!
- We recently received approval from the Association for New Canadians (ANC) to engage with their staff and members. We have started to work ANC on how the ANC can be involved.
- A research application for NL Health approval is being submitted.
- The Public Legal Information Association of Newfoundland and Labrador, our province's only non-profit organization exclusively dedicated to public legal education and information has agreed to work with us on the Accessibility project.

New Collaborators

Association for New Canadians (ANC)

Public Legal Information Association of NL

NLSA Bursary Program



The NLSA, a small volunteer driven not-for profit organization main source of revenue is our Annual ... “a million things I need to say”, 1K /5K Walk, Run and Roll for Stuttering Awareness and Bursary Program Fundraiser. With the support of individuals, community businesses, corporate donors, sponsors and a government grant, the NLSA was able to successfully continue its Bursary Program. These bursaries help subsidize specialized treatment and equipment for people who stutter, others with communication disorders, their families in financial need. Applications for bursaries submitted shared their individual heart wrenching stories. These stories were testimonials, as evidence that clearly identified deficiencies and inadequacies of a broken antiquated current supports and services system, not only for the stuttering community but also for others who are challenged with communications disorders and for families in our province. These stories definitely shed a painful spotlight on accessibility barriers and gaps in our provinces existing limited treatment supports and services and also shed a spotlight for the need for additional supports and services to be established. The NLSA Bursary Program is a priority outreach area and we continue to explore all revenue funding opportunities to be able to expand our Bursary Program. The NLSA is committed to continuing our Annual Bursary Program.

Thank you for helping those with communication challenges to communicate easier.

Dec. 2025 & Jan. 2026

Newfoundland and Labrador



YOUR INVITED TO NLSA MONTHLY IN-PERSON AND VIRTUAL KITCHEN PARTY

WEDNESDAY JANUARY 28, 2026!

Join us for the Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association '**Kitchen Party**'. The Kitchen Party, NLSA's SUPPORT GROUP is a welcoming and safe space where we welcome, stutter, chat, laugh, cry and find community! A space where the global stuttering community, new to the community or a familiar face, no matter where you live there's always a place at the Kitchen Table waiting for you.

You can drop in online from anywhere in the world or join us in person. **Attending Virtually:** Email info@nlstuttering.ca to request a zoom meeting link.

**TIME: Last Wednesday of every month
6:30pm to 7:45pm NL Time.**

City of Mount Pearl Public Library (Main Floor Study Room)
65 Olympic Drive
709-368-3603
Free parking available

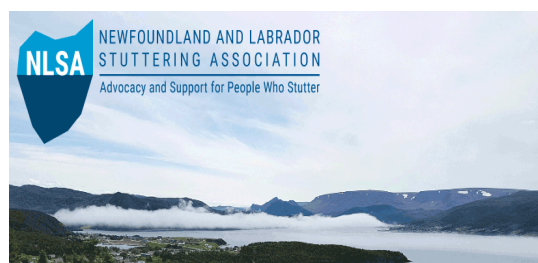
Time: Jan. 28, 2026 06:30 PM Newfoundland and Labrador. Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/81181904120?pwd=oRGe8HdxFr8Vjsn9YR4vdacAerkj3n.1>

Meeting ID: 811 8190 4120
Passcode: 364519

Dec. 2025 & Jan. 2026

Newfoundland and Labrador



The Canadian Stuttering Association (CSA) and the Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association (NLSA) are thrilled to announce that we will host a joint conference in 2026! While the date and venue are still being finalized, the planning team has narrowed down our venue selection to 2 hotels. Both hotels' locations are in the historic centre of St. John's and is in proximity to the water. This conference will unite Canadians who stutter and allies from coast to coast. The conference will take place in St. John's, Newfoundland. Stay tune for continued updates.

We look forward to seeing you all there in 2026!



MEET STARS HOST

Gerald A. Maguire, MD President and Founder of STARS

<https://stutteringresearch.org/>

INTRODUCING STARS SPEAKS PODCAST

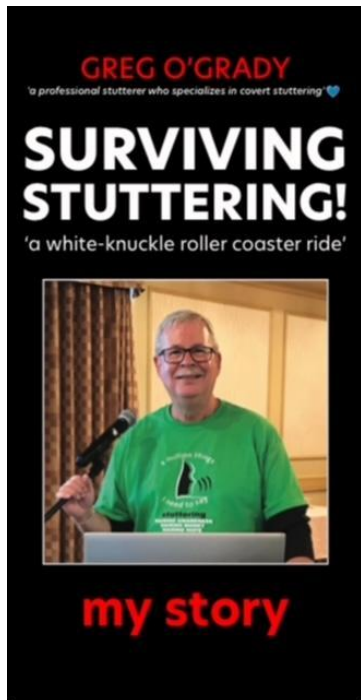
Stuttering Treatment & Research Society (STARS) has introduced their new Podcast. Each episode speaks with leading researchers, clinicians, and voices in the stuttering community to share clear, accessible updates on what neuroscience is revealing about stuttering—and how this knowledge can help shape the future of care. Below are links to these exciting and informative latest episodes.

<https://stutteringresearch.org/podcast/the-research-behind-stuttering-part-1/>

<https://stutteringresearch.org/podcast/personal-journeys-through-stuttering/>

STARS SPEAKS Host, Gerald A. Maguire, MD, unpacks what we don't yet know about the science behind stuttering—and the path of developing new therapies today while discovering the cures for tomorrow.

Whether you're a clinician, researcher, or a member of the stuttering community, this podcast offers expert insights, honest dialogue, and a deeper look at the path forward.



Available on Amazon Books Canada

Since retirement Greg has revisited and dissected his life in order to find out what happened in his life and why it happened in his life. His journey led him to write his MEMOIR. A Memoire about SURVIVING STUTTERING! 'a white-knuckle roller coaster ride' and about Discovering his 'AUTHENTIC VOICE', and about Discovering his 'AUTHENTIC SELF'. A story about the bad, the ugly, the good and a story of 'CELEBRATION'. As a person who stutters, by sharing his story is an opportunity to create awareness, education, understanding, acceptance of stuttering. Sharing of his story is an opportunity to challenge stigma and dismantling of barriers, ensuring equitable access and creating of an inclusive society that values, embraces and empowers diversity. The message in his story applies to everyone: as so many human beings might get dealt difficult cards in one way or another. No one makes it through life without being casualties of unforeseen challenges and circumstances. The challenge for all of us, is how we individually prepare, respond to and cope with addressing our personal challenges as we attempt to journey towards a fully functional and productive life.

Phase 2 of the *OER Stuttering Poster Project*.

Ciao

mi chiamo

*Voglio soltanto poter
dire il mio nome*



Hello

my name is

*I just want to be
able to say my name*



Building on the success of the NLSA OER on Stuttering – Phase 1, NLSA continues to move forward with Phase 2 of the *OER Stuttering Poster Project*. This project continues to grow in scope and inclusivity. Phase 2 expands accessibility by translating posters into other languages to ensure diversity and inclusivity. Phase 2 is creating a repository for these posters. Once Phase 2 is completed and a repository of posters is created, a repository link will be emailed to NL Schools, Post Secondary schools and community agency stakeholders for distribution. Having access to a Poster repository link will help individual schools and community agency stakeholders to review availability of poster languages and to help decide which posters they will be requesting for their individual areas.

Another idea being discussed is instead of mirroring the Phase 1 posters template, discussions are around developing individual posters with graphics, images, pictures and colors reflecting their cultural language / heritage identified. Phase 2 of the *OER Stuttering Poster Project* ensures that every student, educator, family and general public will have access to resources that reflect the diversity of NL.

**NLSA plans to Launch Phase 2 during
Speech and Hearing month in May 2026.**

Volunteer Spotlight



CRISTINA VARGAS GASCA ...

Cristina Vargas Gasca, originally from Mexico is a MA linguistics student at Memorial University of Newfoundland. As a non-stuttering Ally, Cristina is a strong social justice advocate for the NL stuttering community. Cristina is a member on the Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association Board of Directors and is a member of the Some Stutter, LUH! Production Team. Her passionate and advocacy work supporting the NL stuttering community is clearly evident in her tireless commitment and involvement within the various NLSA / MUN / SSL! Podcast community outreach projects and initiatives. Cristina thank you for being such a significant and instrumental ***ALLY 'VOICE' and 'FORCE'*** for the NL stuttering community.

Some Stutter, Luh!

Newfoundland and Labrador's first podcast about communicating differently is entering its 8th Season of Production.



Please join the SSL! Production Team in Celebrating SSL! entering its 8th Season of Production. SSL! embraces all forms of communication, recognizing that differences in speech and language are part of the rich diversity that makes us human. Through our podcasts, we explore the unique experiences of people who stutter and others with communication challenges, addressing the myths, prejudices, and social pressures they encounter. By valuing every voice—whether fluent, disfluent, or somewhere in between—we aim to foster understanding and acceptance. We believe that all forms of communication deserve to be heard and respected. Together, we are changing how we talk about talking. SSL! is produced by members of the Communication Collaborative, a research group in solidarity with The Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association (NLSA) and those with speech, language and voice

differences living in the Canadian province of Newfoundland and Labrador. Since production SSL! podcast has successfully expanded Globally. ...

For more information, here is the link to our website so that you can read about us and listen to our recent episodes.

<http://sometutterluh.ca>

SLL! Production Team appreciates our community efforts in promoting *Some Stutter, Luh!*

**‘BLOCKS’ ENTERS ITS 3RD YEAR OF
PRODUCTION ON
FRIDAY FEBRUARY 20th 2026.**



Join the SSL! Production Team in Celebrating the upcoming 3rd Anniversary of the Launch of Some Stutter, Luh! **‘BLOCKS’**. **‘BLOCKS’ was officially Launched on Friday February 16, 2024.** ‘BLOCKS’ program is live from CHMR 93.5 FM, Newfoundland's Alternative Broadcasting studio on the campus of Memorial University. Some Stutter, Luh! is a production of the Communication Collaborative and is in solidarity with the Newfoundland and Labrador Stuttering Association.

BLOCKS’ MESSAGE: BREAKING BARRIERS – EMBRACING DIFFERENCES. ‘BLOCKS’ aims to challenge stigma and dismantling of barriers, ensuring equitable access and creating of an inclusive society that values, embraces and empowers diversity.

Join our Host Greg O’Grady, a DJ who stutters. Who ever thought that an individual who has struggled since birth with a severe stutter, a stutter, that out of shame and embarrassment he masked by smoke and mirrors for decades, could be a DJ on a live radio show; **‘NOT Greg’!** Well, he is witness to what he considered a ‘BLOCK’ his stutter, that his stutter would work to his advantage.

So, join Greg on Fridays on MUN CHMR 93.5 from 10 am - 11 am. as he operates a consul of a plethora



of knobs, switches and microphones providing listeners a weekly live program about ‘BLOCKS’

Pictures: Dr. Paul De Decker, Associate Professor of Linguistics at MUN and SSL! Producer, (right), Luca Dinu, previous SSL! Production Manager (left), Host Greg O’Grady (middle) and Rhea Rollmann (she/her), Studio Station Manager, CHMR-FM a few weeks prior meeting to discuss and prepare for the Official Launch of SSL! ‘BLOCKS’.

Thank You

We’re grateful to all our members, partners, and supporters who make this work possible. Together, we’re building a Newfoundland and Labrador where every voice - fluent or no